Cause: Intel's 850 chipset motherboard includes RIMM sockets as a support for RDRAM. Usually, the board has four slots. RDRAM works in pairs, so for 256 MB, you will need two identical modules of 128 MB each and two 'dummy' modules, or four modules of 64 MB each. The latter option will limit the scope of upgrading.

Dummy' modules are used to enable conductivity in empty sockets. If the sockets are left open, then the RIMM issues a failure error and the system won't boot.

Solution: Keep the RIMM slots/sockets occupied with compatible RDRAM or 'dummy' (or conductivity) modules. Also make sure the modules in the pair are identical.

▸ **Problem**: Frequent Reboots

Windows restarts frequently.

Cause: Recurring restarts can arise due to problems in both hardware and software. As far as RAM is concerned, it can be caused due to electrostatic discharge (ESD), overheating, corrosion at the contacts, a module mismatch, or a faulty power supply.

Solution: Replace the memory module for damage due to ESD. To avoid such damage, apply anti-static measures—use anti-static gloves, and keep materials that attract static charges away from your work area.

Use stabilisers or high-end SMPSes to eliminate errors caused by faulty power supplies. Clean the contact surface of the memory and socket if you suspect corrosion to be the cause of constant restarts.

▸ **Problem**: Registry Error

Windows prompts you to restart and restore the machine stating a registry error.

Cause: Windows writes a large part of its registry into the RAM. If the RAM is faulty, Windows finds it difficult to read the registry, and so prompts the user to restart and restore the system.

Solution: Replace your system RAM with a known working piece of RAM. Use the machine as you would normally, for diagnostic purposes. If the system runs without any glitches, then go through the procedure of isolation to identify which module is corrupt, and replace it with a new one.